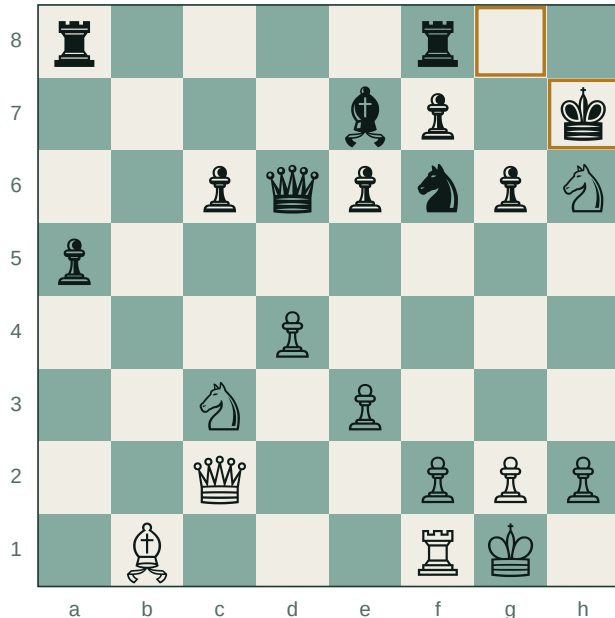


Attraction tactics: White, move 23

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 22...Kh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Nxf7 Rxf7 24. Qxg6+ Kh8 25. Qxf7

23.Nxf7 The knight captures the pawn on f7. Recorded reply: **23...Rxf7**.

24.Qxg6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g6 it attacks king on h7, rook on f7 and knight on f6. Recorded reply: **24...Kh8**.

25.Qxf7 The queen captures the rook on f7. From f7 it attacks knight on f6 and bishop on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.